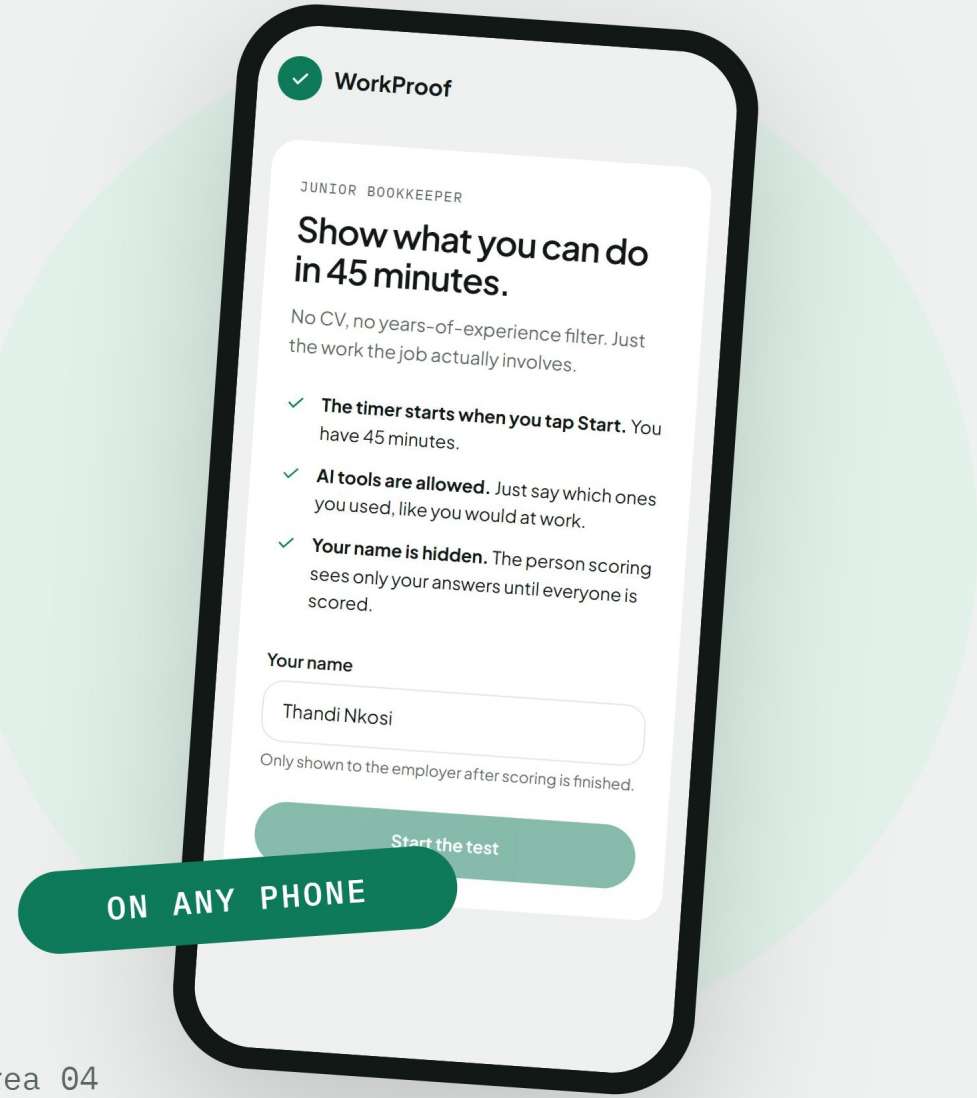
WorkProof

~~Minimum 2 years' experience~~

Proof you can do the job. Not just a CV.

A 45-minute test of the real work, sent to candidates' phones and scored blind.



Yaseen Selemane · Richfield Credify System Thinking Challenge 2026 Area 04

THE PROBLEM

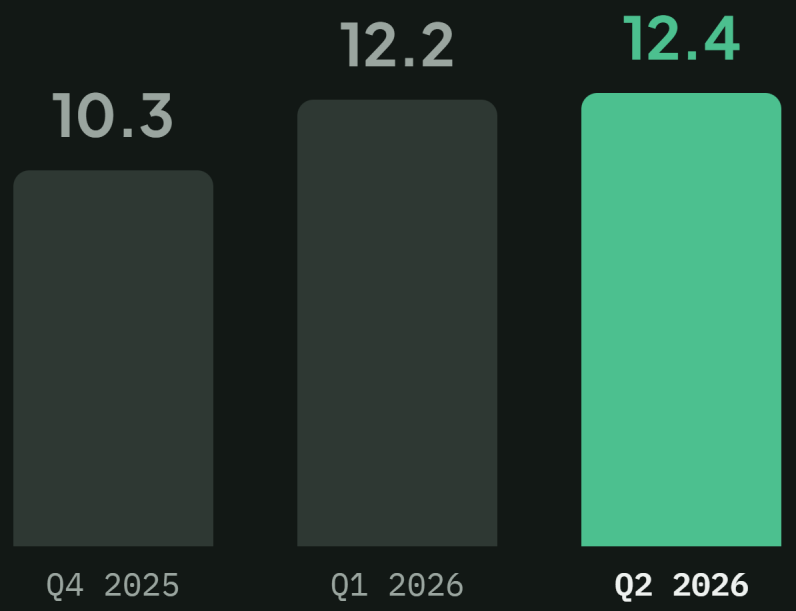
Graduate unemployment rose in two quarters.

12.4%

of South African graduates were unemployed in Q2 2026, up from 10.3% six months earlier.

47.4%
youth unemployment, ages 15 to 34

36.4%
of 15 to 24 year olds not in work, education or training



Source: Stats SA, Quarterly Labour Force Survey, Q2 2026 (11 Aug 2026)

THE EXPERIMENT SOUTH AFRICA ALREADY RAN

The state pays employers to hire young people. Graduates still wait.

THE STATE

Hiring 18–29s is already subsidised.

Employment Tax Incentive, claimed on the monthly EMP201

+

THE RESULT

Yet graduate unemployment rose anyway.

Stats SA QLFS: 10.3% in Q4 2025, 12.4% in Q2 2026

=

SO

Cost isn't the whole story. Judgement is.

Employers still can't tell which graduate is capable.

The ETI lowers the cost of a wrong hire. WorkProof lowers the chance of one.

STAKEHOLDERS AND THE CURRENT SYSTEM

The hiring manager holds the power.

DECIDES

The hiring manager

Wants someone who can do the work in month one.

A bad junior hire costs months of supervision, in public. A missed good hire costs nothing anyone measures.

Most power · most risk

Graduate

Wants a first chance to show the work.

Can apply, then wait.

Recruiter or HR

Wants a short shortlist, fast.

Can filter on years and degrees.

Government · ETI

Wants young people in work.

Can lower the cost, not the risk.

Evidence platforms

Wants graduates placed: universities, portfolio sites, Credify.

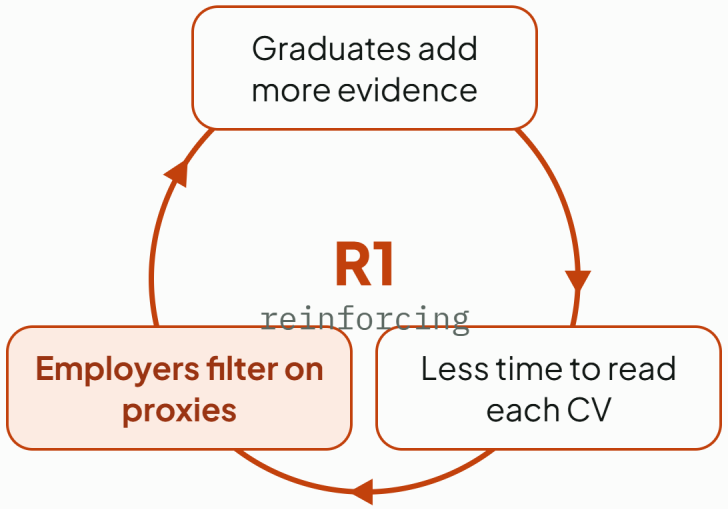
Can inform the decision, not make it.

ROOT CAUSES

Two loops keep graduates out.

Signal saturation

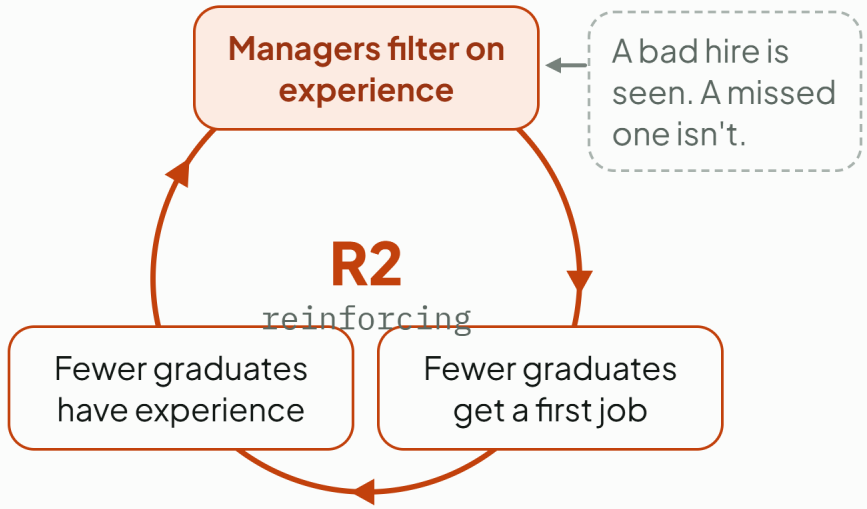
More evidence, less read



WorkProof cuts in: a work sample replaces the proxy filter.

Risk asymmetry

Safe to say no



WorkProof cuts in: a short test makes a wrong call cheap, and traceable.

Proxy: a requirement that stands in for ability without testing it, like “2+ years”.

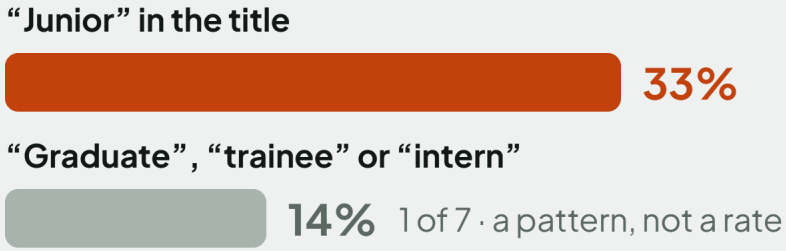
EVIDENCE · LIVE JOB ADS, 28 OCT 2026

“Junior” has become the word for experienced but cheap.

1 in 3

“Junior” ads ranked Intermediate or higher in the employer's own level field: **10 of 30**.





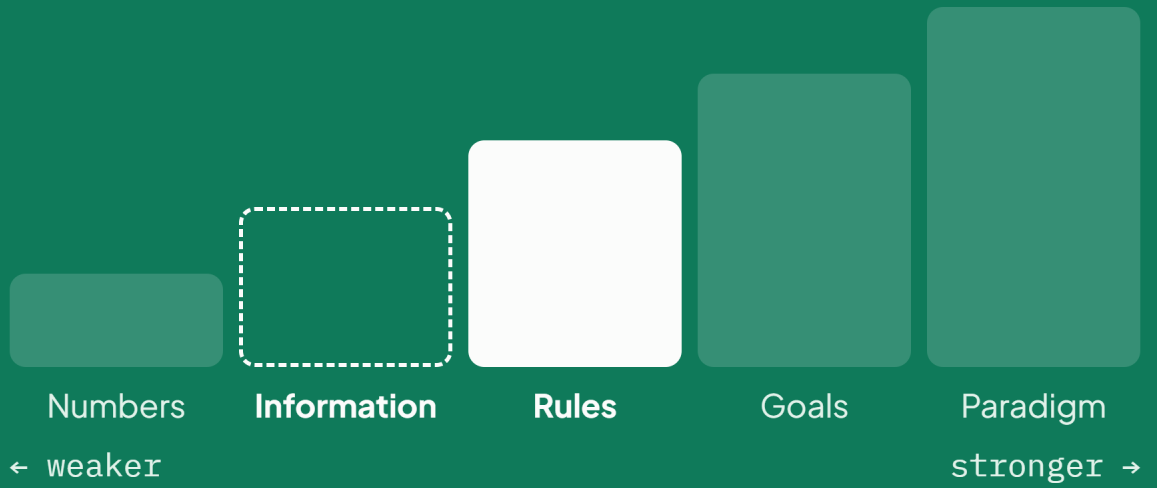
> **“Minimum 8–10 years' experience in construction.”**
>
> Pnet ad: “Junior contracts manager”

Source: every live CareerJunction result for “junior” (59 ads). Data in the repo.

THE INSIGHT

Make being wrong about a graduate cheap.

WHERE TO PUSH ON THE SYSTEM



Graduates already send more evidence than anyone has time to read. So WorkProof changes how the employer decides, instead of adding to the pile.

Information

Portfolio platforms add evidence to a channel that's already full.

Rules

WorkProof changes how the decision is made, and who pays for it.

Leverage points: Donella Meadows, 1999 (simplified)

HOW IT WORKS

Five steps from ad to decision.



01

Ad X-ray

Marks each line of the ad as proxy, trainable or real task, and rewrites the ad without proxies.



02

Kit

Turns the real tasks into three abilities, a 45-minute test and a four-level scoring sheet.



03

Live link

A QR code. Candidates test on their own phones, and each gets their own planted errors.



04

Blind score

Answers arrive in about two seconds, by number. Names unlock after the last score.



05

Receipt

Scores, declared AI use and the decision. The invite or feedback is emailed in one click.



THE LIVE DEMO

The filter you didn't use.

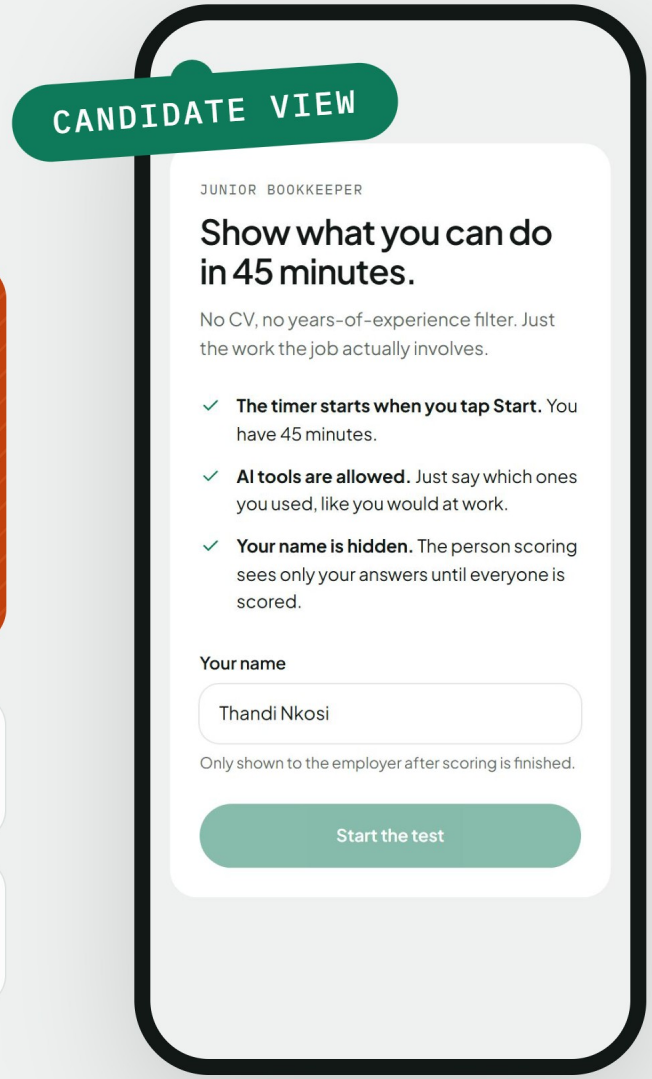
THE FILTER YOU DIDN'T USE

Your ad's “2+ years” rule would have rejected your top scorer.

Lerato Mokoena scored 11/12 with 0 years' experience.

Lerato Mokoena	Candidate 02	0 yrs · old filter: rejected	11/12
Naledi Khoza	Candidate 13	3 yrs · old filter: passed	7/12

The scorer never sees years of experience. This appears only after every answer is scored.



Try it live: workproof-gray.vercel.app · sample data

FEASIBILITY

It runs today, on a free tier.

R0
to run, on Supabase's free tier

~2 s
from Submit to the employer's inbox

45 min
per test, on any phone, no app

19
automated tests on the core logic

6
locked database functions, no open tables

1 link
is all a candidate needs: no account

RISKS, TRADE-OFFS AND FAIRNESS

Where it could go wrong.

RISK	WHAT WORKPROOF DOES
AI does the test	AI is allowed and declared, as at work. Each candidate gets different planted errors, and one live question checks they understand.
Bias in scoring	Scoring is blind: numbers only until the last score. Age is never asked. Proxies that screen by circumstance get a fairness flag.
Candidate data leaks	No table is open to the browser; every read goes through locked functions. The live channel carries pings, never answers.
Asks more of candidates `trade-off`	45 minutes is more than a CV upload. In return: no CV filter, and written feedback for every candidate.
Small numbers mislead	Check-ins are shown as a signal, not a statistic. Years are self-reported and used only after scoring.

EXPECTED IMPACT AND HOW WE'LL MEASURE IT

Every hire tests the test.

1. **Graduates shortlisted with no experience**
   Counted by the filter comparison on every test
2. **Whether the test predicts the job**
   90-day check-ins against test scores
3. **Ads rewritten without proxies**
   Rewritten ads employers copy and post
4. **Feedback reaching candidates**
   Receipts with written feedback, after every decision

NEXT

Pilot with small employers hiring junior bookkeepers.

Employer accounts, rate limiting, and kits for more roles.

With consent, share verified results with platforms like Credify.

workproof-gray.vercel.app
github.com/yaseenselemane/workproof

Make being wrong about a graduate cheap.